

**CHAD**

Capital city: Ndjamena
Area: 495,752 sq miles (1,284,000 sq km)
Population: 8,600,000
Official language: Arabic, French
Major religions: Muslim 55%, traditional beliefs 35%, Christian 10%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: CFA franc
Adult literacy rate: 46%
Life expectancy: 48 years
People per doctor: 33,333
Televisions: 1 per 1,000 people

SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE

Capital city: São Tomé
Area: 386 sq miles (1,001 sq km)
Population: 175,883
Official language: Portuguese
Major religions: Christian 84%, other 16%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Dobra
Adult literacy rate: 83%
Life expectancy: 66 years
People per doctor: 2,000
Televisions: 163 per 1,000 population

The creole people of São Tomé and Príncipe are called *filhos de terra*, which is Portuguese for "sons of the earth."

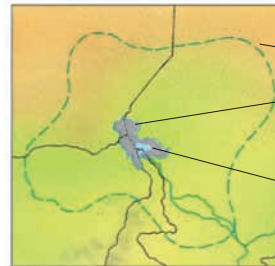


CHAD

MUCH OF CHAD falls inside a wide belt of hot, dry grassland called the Sahel, which extends across the African continent. Drought is a frequent occurrence in the Sahel. This has proved a disaster for Chad because its economy is heavily dependent on agriculture. However, the recent discovery of oil has started to bring wealth into the country. Politically, Chad remains an unstable place.



Camels being brought to drink at the waters of Lake Chad



Original size of the lake, more than one million years ago

Areas of damp, fertile land are left behind as the waters of the lake retreat.

Lake Chad today

DISAPPEARING WATERS

Lake Chad was once a huge expanse of water that formed the meeting point of Chad, Cameroon, Niger, and Nigeria. In the past, water poured into Lake Chad from surrounding rivers, but as the climate has become drier (over the past 10,000 years), the lake has dried up. The shrinking lake poses a serious problem for the local people, who rely on its fish for food.

Gourds are one of the crops grown on the fertile land surrounding Lake Chad. When cut and dried, gourds can be carved and decorated.



SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE

THE VOLCANIC ISLANDS of São Tomé and Príncipe lie off the coast of Equatorial Guinea and Gabon. Dense tropical forest cloaks the upper slopes while lower down farms and large plantations growing cocoa and sugar can be found. The islands were ruled by Portugal until 1975. Today, the people make a living from farming and fishing, and cocoa remains a vital crop.

CREOLE CULTURE

No one was living on these islands when the Portuguese first landed in the 1400s. Soon a population was built of slaves imported from the mainland. Today, one of the main groups of people combine both African and Portuguese ancestry, and have created a Creole culture with a distinctive language and style of building.



VOLCANIC LANDSCAPE

This part of Africa lies on a fault line – a crack in the Earth's crust. Molten rock can seep through this crack and cool to form volcanoes. These islands are the peaks of such volcanoes. Their soil is enriched by volcanic ash, which makes it extremely fertile.

Find out more

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